

Excel – Class 4 Notes

Paste Values, Text Functions, FIND, SEARCH, CONCAT, TEXTJOIN, SUBSTITUTE & REPLACE

1. Copy Only Values

Purpose: Copy only the result/value from a cell without copying its formula or formatting.

Shortcut: Select cells → **Ctrl + C** → destination cell → **Alt + Ctrl + V** → choose **Values** → Enter/OK.

Example: If A1 contains =UPPER(B1), Paste Values copies only the displayed result, not the formula.

2. FIND Function

Definition: Finds the position of text inside another text. FIND is **case-sensitive**.

Syntax: =FIND(find_text, within_text, [start_num])

Example: =FIND("a", "Bangalore") returns the position of lowercase "a".

3. SEARCH Function

Definition: Finds the position of text inside another text. SEARCH is **not case-sensitive** and supports wildcards.

Syntax: =SEARCH(find_text, within_text, [start_num])

Example: =SEARCH("A", "Bangalore") can find "a" despite the different case.

4. CONCAT Function

Definition: Joins two or more text values into one text value.

Syntax: =CONCAT(text1, text2, ...)

Example: =CONCAT(A1, " ", B1) joins first name and last name with a space.

5. TEXTJOIN Function

Definition: Joins multiple text values using a **delimiter** such as a space, comma, hyphen, etc. It can also ignore empty cells.

Syntax: =TEXTJOIN(delimiter, ignore_empty, text1, [text2], ...)

Example 1: =TEXTJOIN(" ", TRUE, A1:C1) joins A1, B1 and C1 with spaces and ignores blank cells.

Example 2: =TEXTJOIN(", ", TRUE, A1:A5) joins values with a comma and space.

CONCAT vs TEXTJOIN: CONCAT joins values directly; TEXTJOIN lets you specify a separator and whether empty cells should be ignored.

6. SUBSTITUTE Function

Definition: Replaces existing matching text with new text.

Syntax: =SUBSTITUTE(text, old_text, new_text, [instance_num])

Example: =SUBSTITUTE("I like Excel", "Excel", "Python") → **I like Python**.

Instance number: The optional fourth argument lets you replace only a particular occurrence.

7. REPLACE Function

Definition: Removes a specified number of characters starting at a specified position and inserts new text.

Syntax: =REPLACE(old_text, start_num, num_chars, new_text)

Example: =REPLACE("ABCDEFGH", 3, 2, "XY") → ABXYEFGH.

8. SUBSTITUTE vs REPLACE

Function	How it works
SUBSTITUTE	Finds matching text and replaces it.
REPLACE	Uses character position and number of characters.

9. Quick Revision

Topic	Remember
Paste Values	Ctrl+C → Alt+Ctrl+V → Values
FIND	Find position; case-sensitive
SEARCH	Find position; not case-sensitive
CONCAT	Join text values
TEXTJOIN	Join text with a delimiter; can ignore blanks
SUBSTITUTE	Replace matching text
REPLACE	Replace characters by position

Class 4 takeaway: Text functions help you search, join, find, and modify text. Remember: SUBSTITUTE works by matching text, REPLACE works by position, and TEXTJOIN is useful when you want to join many values with a separator.